

Kill Your Darlings: Curate Your Images

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Track: General AI Fluency

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My Image Selection Approach

For my portfolio, I decided that the images should support the work rather than simply make the website look more decorative. Most of the important images will be real captures of my projects, because screenshots and actual project visuals provide evidence of what I have built and worked on.

AI generated visuals will only be used where they make sense as supporting visuals, such as a hero background or subtle decorative elements. These visuals will follow the same visual identity as my portfolio so that they feel consistent with the rest of the design.

Images My Portfolio Needs

SyncWorks Logo

Source: Real

The SyncWorks logo is an existing part of my brand identity, so I will use the original logo rather than generating a replacement.

Profile Photo

Source: Real

I will use a real photograph of myself for the About section. Since the image represents me personally, an AI generated portrait would not accurately represent the person behind the work.

FlyRank Research Question Notebook

Source: Real

I will use a clean screenshot from my actual research question notebook. This shows the work I completed during the internship and provides evidence of the project rather than creating a fictional representation.

FlyRank ML Task Framing Notebook

Source: Real

I will use a screenshot from my actual ML task framing notebook. It shows how I defined the problem, target, unit of analysis, and ML task.

FlyRank GitHub Repository

Source: Real

A screenshot of my GitHub repository can be used to show the actual project structure and completed work. This gives visitors a direct view of the project rather than relying only on a description.

Content Refresh Opportunity Scoring Work

Source: Real

Screenshots of the actual analysis, code, tables, charts, or future ranking results will be used as the project develops. These images will be updated as more work is completed.

Other Completed Projects

Source: Real

For other projects in my portfolio, I will use screenshots and captures from the actual applications, websites, dashboards, or systems I built. The images should clearly show the real work and important parts of each project.

Portfolio Hero Visual

Source: AI generated or designed

A supporting visual can be used in the hero section if it improves the presentation. It will not represent a real project or claim to be a screenshot of my work. Its purpose will only be to establish the visual style of the portfolio.

Small Supporting Graphics

Source: AI generated or designed

Only a small number of supporting graphics will be used when they improve the layout or help connect sections. They will follow the same visual style instead of introducing unrelated designs.

Where I Chose Real Images Over AI

I chose real screenshots for my projects because they provide evidence of the work I actually completed. Generating a similar looking dashboard or notebook would make the portfolio look polished but would not prove that I built the work.

I also chose a real photograph for my profile instead of an AIgenerated portrait because the image represents me personally.

Rejected Generated Image

I rejected one generated hero visual because it was too detailed and distracting. It looked visually impressive, but it competed with the content instead of supporting it. I preferred a simpler visual that keeps attention on the actual projects.

Final Image Direction

The final collection will mainly consist of real project screenshots, the actual SyncWorks logo, and a real profile photograph. Generated visuals will only be used for supporting elements where there is no real project image to show, and they will follow the same minimal visual style as the portfolio.